

better utilisation of the bank's growing balance sheet. At the same time, net interest income rose 137% from ₹1,011 crore in FY20 to ₹2,393 crore in FY25.

Profitability has also improved significantly over the period. The bank's profit after tax (PAT) rose from ₹30 crore in FY20 to ₹501 crore in FY25. In this duration, total assets expanded steadily from ₹14,145 crore in FY20 to ₹38,464 crore in FY25, underlining consistent balance sheet growth.

Explaining the transformation over the last few years, Ajay Kanwal, Managing Director and CEO of Jana Small Finance Bank, highlights a conscious shift in strategy. "Over the last three to five years, Jana Small Finance Bank has consciously transformed challenges into opportunities, evolving from a strong microfinance legacy into a diversified and resilient banking platform aligned with our vision of being the anchor bank for a rising and *atmanirbhar* India," he says.

A key part of this journey has been the bank's focus on customer engagement and technology-led delivery. "By prioritising a tech-and-touch model and delivering personalised services across 15 regional languages, the bank has built deep and enduring customer loyalty," he says.

Importantly, the transformation has not come at the cost of growth. The bank's advances under management and deposits grew at a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of 21% and 25%, respectively, between FY20 and FY25, underscoring the sustainability of the business model.

Looking ahead, Jana Small Finance Bank sees meaningful opportunities. "The next three to four years hold significant promise for Jana as we further

strengthen our role as an anchor bank," says Kanwal. The bank plans to scale integrated offerings such as Home360 and expand its MSME franchise, while ensuring strong execution and risk control as the business grows.

Talent acquisition, cyber security, and data protection will be important focus areas as the

moves decisively towards becoming a ₹5 trillion economy." The bank expects revival of rural demand, improved MSME activity, and recovery in microfinance in the second half of FY26 to unlock further opportunities.

Market experts also see the environment turning favourable. Kranthi Bathini, Director

WHAT THE NUMBERS SAY

● Performance of the top 5 small finance banks

RANK	BANK	TOTAL ASSETS	GROWTH IN TOTAL DEPOSITS (%)	NET NPA (%)	NET SECURED ADVANCES (%)	RETURN ON ASSETS (%)
1	Jana SFB	38,464	29.01%	0.48%	68.75%	1.41%
2	Unity SFB	19,152	83.73%	1.54%	36.62%	2.93%
3	Ujjivan SFB	47,689	19.61%	0.49%	42.62%	1.65%
4	Equitas SFB	52,836	19.31%	0.98%	87.66%	0.30%
5	Capital SFB	10,108	11.30%	1.30%	99.90%	1.36%

NOTE FIGURES IN ₹ CRORE; SFB IS SMALL FINANCE BANK; NPA IS NON-PERFORMING ASSETS; DATA FOR FY25 **SOURCE** BT-KPMG SURVEY OF INDIA'S BEST BANKS AND NBFCs

bank expands into new products and customer segments. The bank also believes its positioning gives it a competitive edge. With 818 branches and over 25,000 employees, supported by a digital-first approach and services offered in more than 15 vernacular languages, Jana believes its model creates a differentiated engagement framework in the sector.

On the broader outlook, the bank sees strong tailwinds ahead. "Our CAGR in the past eight years has been nearly three times India's GDP growth, and we see this momentum sustaining as the country

– Equity Strategy, WealthMills Securities Pvt. Ltd., says, "As far as Jana Small Finance Bank is concerned, the interest rate cycle has now entered a more traditional phase, which could be advantageous for small finance banks, especially those focused on microfinance."

Jana Small Finance Bank's rise has been built on steady execution rather than quick wins. As the sector enters a more stable phase, the bank appears well placed to build on its gains. **BT**

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